

Corso di Laurea Magistrale in Ingegneria e Scienze Informatiche

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Abstract

Max 2000 characters, strict.

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Chapter 1

Intro (motivazione, contesto, obiettivi)

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You can use acronyms that you defined previously, such as Internet of Things (IoT). If you use acronyms twice, they will be written in full only once (indeed, you can mention the IoT now without it being fully explained). In some cases, you may need a plural form of the acronym. For instance, that you are discussing Virtual Machines (VMs), you may need both VM and VMs.

Marco Raggini: Add sidenotes in this way. They are named after the author of the thesis

Structure of the Thesis

Marco Raggini: At the end, describe the structure of the paper

Chapter 2

Background

2.1 Large Language Models

Large Language Models (LLMs) is a subcategory of Artificial Intelligence (AI), and more specifically, they belong to the field of Deep Learning. In recent years, they have become extremely popular thanks to their ability to understand and generate natural language with a high level of fluency and coherence. Their generalized knowledge and versatility make them perfect for a wide range of applications, from text generation and translation to code assistance, question answering, and conversational systems.

The ability to generate natural language fits perfectly with the need to create systems that can be used by everyone without requiring specific technical knowledge. Unlike traditional software interfaces, which often require predefined commands or structured inputs, LLMs allow users to interact using natural language, making human-computer interaction more intuitive and accessible.

During the last years, after the release of ChatGPT, the average number of arXiv papers that contain the “*large language model*” title or abstract are deduplicated [ZZL⁺26], leading to the development of increasingly powerful models such as GPT-4 [OAA⁺24], LLaMA [TMS⁺23], Gemini, and Claude [Ant24]. These systems are capable not only of understanding and generating text, but also of solving

reasoning tasks, summarizing documents, writing code, and supporting decision-making processes, becoming more and more used in real-world scenarios.

2.1.1 How they work

LLMs are autoregressive models that simply try to predict the next word in a sequence, based on the context.

The text given as input to the LLM is preprocessed by the model, dividing it into smaller units called *tokens*. A token may represent a word, part of a word, or even a symbol, depending on the strategy chosen. The next step is to convert the tokens into numbers. This process permits the neural network to process textual information mathematically.

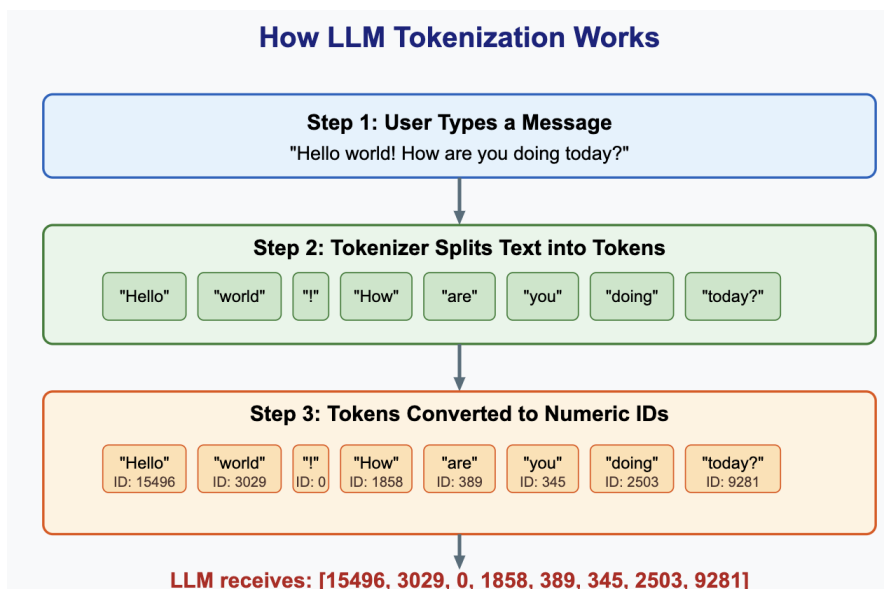


Figure 2.1: Schematic workflow of an LLM tokenizer: from raw input text to token segmentation and subsequent mapping into vocabulary IDs. Source: <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/llm-tokenizers-hidden-engine-behind-ai-language-models-natarajan-rmbsc>

Modern LLMs are typically based on the Transformer architecture introduced by Vaswani [VSP⁺23]. The Transformer uses the self-attention mechanism to

capture contextual relationships between tokens, allowing the model to understand long-range dependencies and generate coherent text.

Once the tokenization is done, the text generation starts using autoregressive algorithm: a token is generated and appended to the input sequence and used to predict the following token. By repeating this process multiple times, the model can generate complete sentences, paragraphs, or entire documents.

Despite the apparent intelligence of these systems, LLMs do not possess real understanding or reasoning capabilities in the human sense. Their outputs are generated through statistical pattern matching learned from training data, which explains their tendency to occasionally produce incorrect or hallucinated information[XJK25] and the standardized phrases that often generates.

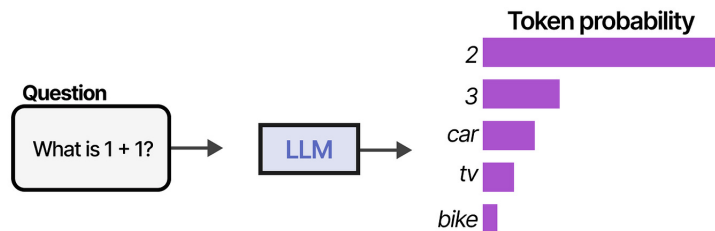


Figure 2.2: Schematic overview of autoregressive decoding and probabilistic next-token prediction in an LLM. Source: https://albanna-tutorials.com/llm_agents.html

Training

Training is the really important part of how LLMs are so good at generating text and responding to general knowledge questions.

Since we have now explained how an LLM works behind the scenes, we also need to discuss their training to understand why they perform so well.

The capabilities of modern LLMs are not the result of a single algorithmic breakthrough, but rather the consequence of a dramatic and sustained growth in the scale of training data.

Before 2018, the growth of pre-training corpora was slow, and models remained limited in scope. The landscape began to shift with the release of models such as

GPT-2, but it was GPT-3 in 2020 that marked a turning point: trained on hundreds of billions of tokens initially drawn from the webtext, books, Wikipedia, and other sources, it demonstrated that scale alone could unlock new capabilities [BMR⁺20]. We may note that the growing power of the Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) plays an important role in the LLMs training speed.

Nowadays, the emphasis on increasing model parameter counts is gradually giving way to research on higher-level capabilities, including autonomous agents and more effective prompting strategies.

2.1.2 Prompt Engineering

Prompt engineering is a relatively new field of research that refers to the practice of designing, refining, and implementing prompts or instructions that guide the output of LLMs. The main goal of Prompt Engineering is to optimize the LLM output by solely refining the prompt[Mes23].

The prompt could comprehend a lot of components, such as: *Directives, Examples, Output formatting, Style instructions, Role* or *Additional Information*[SIB⁺24]. All of these components can help to improve the generated output in terms of a better style, accuracy in the response, or even a more correct output.

One of the most popular and older prompt engineering techniques is the *Few Shot Prompting*[BMR⁺20], in particular, it has three sub categories:

- **Few-Shot:** We are referring to a prompt that comprehends a few examples of how the output should be structured with also the correct output. This context helps the LLM to learn how to complete the task given without updating the model parameters.
- **One-Shot:** It is equal to the few-shot prompting, with only one demonstration allowed and the natural language description of the problem.
- **Zero-Shot:** In this case, no demonstrations are allowed. The prompt contains only the natural language description of the task. This method has the maximum convenience, but could be challenging to apply, mainly due to the difficulty of imagining the format expected without producing examples.

These methods are not meant to compete with each other. There are three possibilities depending on the task that we require of the LLM. In general, few-shot prompting tends to perform better on structured or domain-specific tasks, while zero-shot prompting is often sufficient for simpler or well-known tasks[BMR⁺20].

2.1.3 LLM-as-a-judge

During the Prompt Engineering discovery, a new way of improving the output is created, the LLM-as-a-judge technique[ZCS⁺23]. The idea is to use Generative AI to judge another LLM output; this method can benefit the output in scalability, explainability and has the advantage of limit the human involvement of the reasoning process.

The three approaches proposed to use the LLM-as-a-judge are:

- **Pairwise comparison** The judge is presented with one question and two or multiple answers. Its goal is to choose which one is better.
- **Single answer grading** It is directly asked to the LLM judge to assign a grade to the solution.
- **Reference-guided grading** In some cases, providing a reference solution may be beneficial.

This technique has also several bias such as **Position bias**, **Verbosity bias** and **Self-enhancement bias**.

2.1.4 Agents

The LLMs are now good enough to start thinking about how to automate some processes or how they can be used in more contexts. For these reasons, the agents are created. The formal definition is:

“An agent is anything that can be viewed as perceiving its environment through sensors and acting upon that environment through effectors.” [RN10]

A high-level description of an agent comprehends:

- **Senses** the surrounding environment around it.
- **Perceives** the information of that environment.
- **Reasons** about how to act based on the input given.
- **Acts** upon the environment through its actions (the output)[RN10].

In the LLM context, the agent brain is supported by the LLM, which reasons using the context given (it could be the environment as a text), and it acts generating an output or by calling the **tools**.

Tools are external functions or Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) that an agent can invoke at runtime to overcome the limitations of the LLM, such as the lack of up-to-date knowledge, the inability to execute code, or the absence of persistent memory. By selecting and calling the appropriate tool based on the user's intent, the agent extends its capabilities well beyond pure language generation.

As we said before, LLMs can be unpredictable and lacks of transparency. In this sense, the usage of tools enhances the credibility of the decision of an agent, improving interpretability and robustness[XCG⁺23].

A difference between pure LLMs and AI agents is the autonomy. While LLMs goal is to generate a correct and coherent output, the agents try to perceive the autonomy, minimizing the need for human intervention, and trying to adapt by changing their behavior based on feedbacks[Kum24].

2.2 LangChain & LangGraph

2.3 Related Works

While few-shot prompting improves performance by providing input-output examples, it does not explicitly guide the model through the reasoning process required to solve a task. The research in this field has been evolved, finding new ways to improve the output quality without changing the LLM parameters.



Figure 2.3: Representation of how an agents works. Source: <https://cobusgreyling.medium.com/how-would-the-architecture-for-an-llm-agent-platform-look-b07d7e004561>

2.3.1 Chain of Thoughts

Recently the CoT[WWS⁺22] prompting is introduced. This prompting techniques reveals that, when LLMs produce the reasoning steps of a solution, the correct results increase dramatically. This leads to a lot of advantages:

- **Accuracy:** As we said previously, the number of corrected answers increase[WWS⁺22].
- **Interpretability:** The LLM remains a black box, but the final solution includes the steps, allowing to understand when the LLM produces an error in the reasoning.
- **Transparency:** In some task categories, such as math problems, the CoT techniques produces the intermediate reasoning which helps to independently reproduce the result given.

The CoT was firstly introduced as a few-shot approach, where the examples were used for enducing the multi steps reasoning. Recently it has been proved that also a zero-shot CoT increases the performance, introducing the “Let’s think step by step” phrase into the prompt[KGR⁺22].

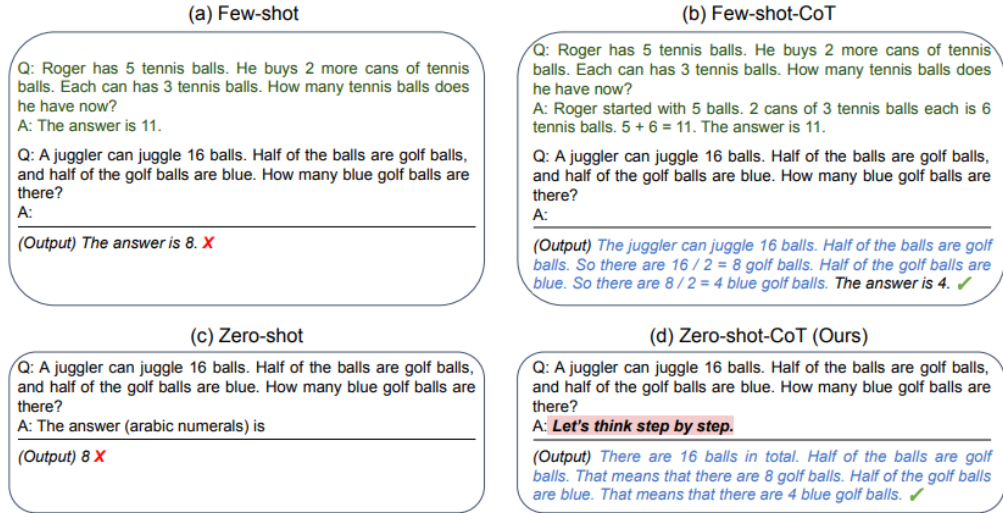


Figure 2.4: The differences between a normal prompt versus a few-shot CoT and a zero-shot CoT. Source: [KGR⁺22]<https://arxiv.org/abs/2205.11916>

Later on, the Self consistency CoT (CoT-SC)[WWS⁺23] was developed as an evolution of the classic CoT. The idea behind that was explore multiple reasoning paths in order to select the most accurate output. The empirical evaluation proved that CoT-SC boost the performance of CoT reasoning[WWS⁺23].

2.3.2 Tree of Thoughts

The introduction of the CoT approach paved the way for a new type of prompt engineering. From this method, the Tree of Thoughts (ToT) was developed[YYZ⁺23]. While the CoT produces multiple steps with a single prompt, the ToT is based on the idea of generating multiple thoughts for each step and evaluating the best of them; each step is a partial solution and the evaluation phase guarantee the refinement of it into the final response. In order to achieve the best result, the architecture comprehends four important parts:

1. **Task decomposition:** In the ToT, the task decomposition is an explicit part. This should helps the LLM to decompose the problem until they are small enough to generate a satisfying solution.
2. **Thought generation:** There are two ways of generating thoughts. The

Samples is useful when the solution space is rich and the *Propose* is more efficient when the solution space is restricted.

3. **State evaluator:** Two strategies were proposed in order to evaluate the thoughts. In the *Value* strategy, the LLMs give a value to each thought from 1 to 10 and chose the higher one. In the *Vote* strategy, each evaluator choose the best thought and who takes more votes become the winner.
4. **Search algorithm:** It is used to search the more accurate solution in the tree; the strategies proposed are the classics, Breadth-first search (BFS) that controls each node at every level of the tree, Depth-first search (DFS) that explores the most promising state first until the final output is reached.

The studies proved that this approach obtains better results than CoT, CoT-SC and the not refined prompt[YYZ⁺23].

2.3.3 Graph of Thoughts

Another evolution of the CoT is the GoT architecture[BBK⁺24]. Besta proposes an architecture where the LLM reasoning process is seen as a graph of thoughts, where each vertex is represented by a thought and the edges are the dependencies. The thoughts dependencies and linking allow the creation of different operations: **Generation**, which produces new thoughts from one or more existing ones; **Aggregation**, which merges multiple thoughts into a single one; and **Refining**, which iteratively improves an existing thought based on self-feedback..

Technically, the reasoning process consists of two main parts:

Graph of Operations (GoO) It is the planning part of the system. The GoO is constructed before the execution starts and it can not be changed during the reasoning process. As the name suggests, it contains all the operations which will be completed during the execution. An important note is that the GoO instance is not generated by the LLM, but is created before by the user.

Graph Reasoning State (GRS) It represents the graph that maintains all the information updated during the execution. The LLM follows the instruction of the

GoO, the output produced is stored in the GRS. Specifically, the GRS tracks the executed operations, the LLM outputs, the score and validity of each thought, along with additional metadata generated throughout the reasoning process.

The research demonstrates that the GoT could perform better than the previously discussed architectures (CoT, ToT)[BBK⁺24].

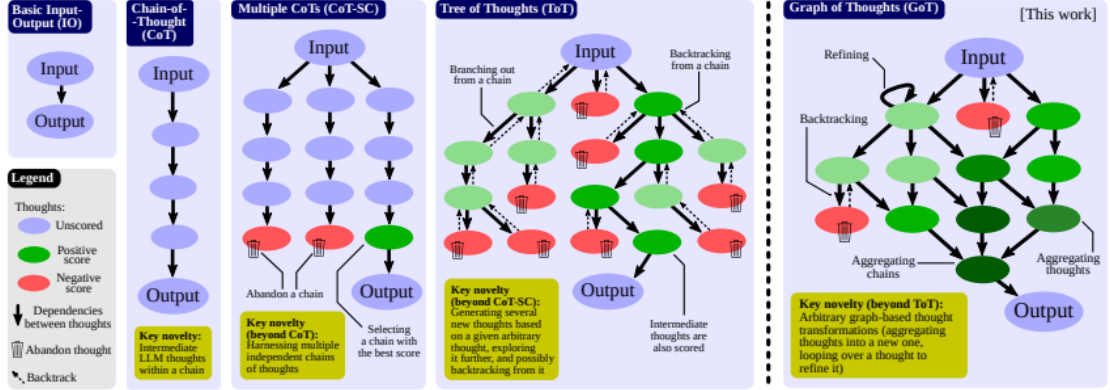


Figure 2.5: Representation of different prompt engineering architectures. Source: [BBK⁺24]<https://arxiv.org/abs/2308.09687>

Chapter 3

Methodology / Design

This chapter presents the proposed approach in detail. We first formally define the problem and highlight the main challenges and requirements. Then, we describe the proposed GoTs, providing its formalization, including algorithmic details and execution strategies. Lastly, we illustrate the approach with a concrete example to demonstrate its application.

3.1 Problem statement

3.1.1 Task Definition

Before introducing the proposed approach, we first formally define the problem addressed in this work.

Given an input problem P expressed in natural language, the objective is to generate a solution S along with a structured reasoning process R that leads to S . The reasoning representation R is composed of multiple intermediate reasoning steps, which may form a non-linear structure. Each step represents a partial inference contributing to the final solution. The overall reasoning process should be coherent, interpretable, and effective in reaching correct answers.

3.1.2 Challenges and Requirements

LLMs are able to generate coherent text and perform reasoning, but as shown in the previous chapter, there are some limitations and challenges that need to be addressed:

- **Limited explorations of alternatives:** The standard approaches, such as CoT and ToT generate a single linear solution, which may not be sufficient to generate a good solution, especially for complex problems that may require more attempts.
- **Black box reasoning:** The reasoning process of LLMs is often difficult to understand and interpret, the generated text is autoregressive and the model does not have a clear representation of the reasoning process, which makes it difficult to debug and improve the model.
- **Error propagation:** If there is an error in the early steps of the reasoning process, it will propagate to the solution. Without more exploration of alternatives, the model may not be able to recover from these errors and may produce incorrect solutions.

In order to address these challenges, the requirements are formalized as follows:

- **Exploration of alternatives:** If the LLM answer does not satisfy evaluation criterias, the model should be able to explore alternatives, which may require the ability to backtrack and try different reasoning paths.
- **Separation of reasoning:** The system should allow starting a new reasoning process independently if a path leads to an incorrect solution, without affecting other trajectories.
- **Structured and interpretable reasoning:** The reasoning process should be captured in a structured representation that enables traceability, interpretability, and evaluation of intermediate steps.

3.1.3 Assumptions

In order to simplify the problem and focus on the core aspects of the GoT paradigm, we make the following assumptions:

- **LLM capabilities:** We assume that the LLM has enough capabilities to use external tools to craft tools if needed to evaluate the generated solutions and to generate intermediate thoughts that are coherent and relevant to the problem at hand. This assumption is strictly dependent on the size of the LLM that we are using.
- **Tool-Centric Problem Domain:** We assume the input problems belong to a class of tasks that cannot be solved through direct, zero-shot text generation alone. The problems are assumed to require non-trivial reasoning sequences and at least one interaction with an external environment or tool (e.g., a calculator, a search engine, or a code interpreter).
- **Thought Atomicity:** We assume that each node in the graph represents an “atomic” step of reasoning or a single functional operation. While the internal process of the LLM remains a black box; the output of each node is treated as a discrete state in the problem-solving space.
- **Resource Finiteness:** We assume the existence of an upper bound on the graph depth and the number of LLM invocations to ensure the termination of the process and to mitigate potential infinite loops caused by recursive backtracking. These assumptions are also valid for time and computational resources, which are limited and should be taken into account when designing the system.

3.2 The proposed approach

The approach proposed in this thesis is based on the GoTs paradigm. In this framework, the reasoning process is modeled as a dynamic graph, where nodes represent intermediate thoughts, and the Large Language Model (LLM) guides

both the expansion of the graph and the decision of when to terminate the reasoning process.

Given an input problem (P), the system incrementally constructs a graph according to a set of high-level rules. These rules are designed to balance the exploration of multiple reasoning paths with the need for coherent and effective problem-solving. Additionally, they encourage the use of external tools, which play a key role in improving traceability and interpretability of the reasoning process.

3.2.1 Motivation for using GoT

The GoT paradigm is chosen for the potential that this structure offers in terms of exploration, combination of different reasoning paths and the ability to backtrack in order to recover from errors.

The second motivation about the use of GoT, as mentioned in the previous chapter, is the fact that the GoT research is still in its early stages, so its potential is not yet fully explored.

3.2.2 Static Graph Structure

As a **static graph**, we refer to the graph structure that is defined at the beginning of the process, which includes the definition of nodes and edges, as well as the rules for how they can be connected. The static graph structure provides a framework for how the reasoning process can be represented and how different thoughts can be connected to each other.

The static graph structure is defined as $G_s = (S, T)$, where S is the set of possible logical states (e.g. Evaluation, Backtracking, Crafting etc.) and T is the set of possible transitions between these states. The states are defined, and they are the following:

__start__ and **__end__** : the start and end states of the process. The **__start__** is the first state reached and the **__end__** is the last reached in the process. These represent entry and exit points and are visited exactly once per execution.

goal This is the first real state. The system starts with the user prompt and the **goal** represents the problem. From here, the system starts to generate thought paths that can be explored in order to solve the problem.

In particular, the system creates four different reasoning paths composed of three **tool_reasoning** nodes and one **reasoning_mode** node. The number of tool reasoning paths created are arbitrary; they are chosen by observing the system's behaviours during its runs. A higher number of reasoning paths can lead to more solutions, but the cost in terms of time and tokens increases.

tool_reasoning This is the starting point of a reasoning path. From here the system starts to think about how to solve the problem without solving it directly in order to force the reasoning to the LLM. The main focus of this state is about how to use the tools or, in some cases, how to craft them. The message history will be used to provide the context in the following states.

tool_calling This state is reached after the **tool_reasoning** and it represents the moment in which the system should call the tool or just generate the solution if the tool is not needed. Since LLMs are stochastic auto-regressive models, we cannot deterministically predict the exact output; however, the system is designed to enforce instruction-following through the provided context. The expected behavior is for the model to generate a response that incorporates tool calls (if deemed necessary) or a direct solution, effectively bridging the gap between reasoning and action.

response_evaluation It is reached after the **tool_calling** or the **reasoning_mode**, and it represents the moment in which the system evaluates the generated response of the reasoning process. This moment is crucial in this structure because the evaluation decides what state must be reached next. The LLM-as-a-judge method is used to evaluate the response. The evaluation is based by the format of the response (sometimes the response should have a fixed format), the correctness of the result, and the explanation of the process. The judge agent has the entire message history, so it has a full vision of the reasoning process. In order to evaluate the response, the LLM must score the solution to a number between 0 and 5, where

5 is the maximum, and also give it a score for the problem complexity. These two parameters are used to decide if the response can pass or not. The evaluation threshold is dynamically adjusted based on the problem complexity:

$$S \geq 5.5 - 0.5 \cdot C \quad (3.1)$$

Where S is the score and $C \in [1, \dots, 5]$ is the complexity. If the problem is too complex, a non-perfect response may be accepted. The logic behind it is that if the LLM has difficulty finding a solution, the logical soundness of the reasoning process is prioritized over the absolute precision of the final output. The LLM can also understand, usually hinted by the tool call response, that a new tool is needed. In this case the next node will be **crafting**.

backtrack It is reached when an evaluation doesn't satisfy the LLM criteria to become a solution. This state allows to backtrack to a previous non-visited reasoning path and explore it, giving also feedbacks to the LLM about what is wrong with the previous path.

crafting It is reached when, after an evaluation, the system identifies that a new tool is needed to solve the problem. In this state, the LLM tries to craft a tool that can solve or can help solving the problem, and then a new reasoning path is chosen for exploration. In this state, a specialized crafter agent generates a new tool definition. This process uses the original problem context (P) and the judge's feedback as a specification. Once the tool is crafted, the system resumes the exploration by expanding a new reasoning path that can now leverage the newly created capability.

reasoning_mode It is a different approach to solve the problem. If the **tool_reasoning** and **tool_calling** states are focused on how to use the tools, the **reasoning_mode** is focused on how to solve the problem using *divide-et-impera* system, so it is more focused on the reasoning capabilities of the LLM. This state is used when the system has difficulties in solving the problem. In the proposed approach, this state is reached when the response does not pass the evaluation and there is no

tool_reasoning node available. The system here has the possibility to divide the thought into two parallel sub-tasks in order to divide the complexity of the single prompt. The two prompts should be independent of each other.

chat_completion Acts as a fallback mechanism to ensure that a response is provided even when complex reasoning paths fail. This state is reached when the system has explored all the possible paths, and it is not able to find a solution, so it calls the LLM to generate a solution without any constraint in order to guarantee the termination of the process.

We partition the set of transitions T into two disjoint subsets: $T = T_d \cup T_c$ where:

- T_d is the set of deterministic transitions, where the next state is uniquely determined by the completion of the current state's task.
- T_c is the set of conditional transitions, where the next state is determined by a selection function $f : \text{output} \rightarrow S$, typically driven by the LLM's internal evaluation or a logic-based heuristic.

While some phases follow a strict sequence—such as the transition from Initialization to Reasoning—others like Backtracking or Crafting are triggered dynamically. Consequently, while the static graph structure defines the set of all possible paths, the actual trajectory is determined only during execution, reflecting the flexible nature of these operations.

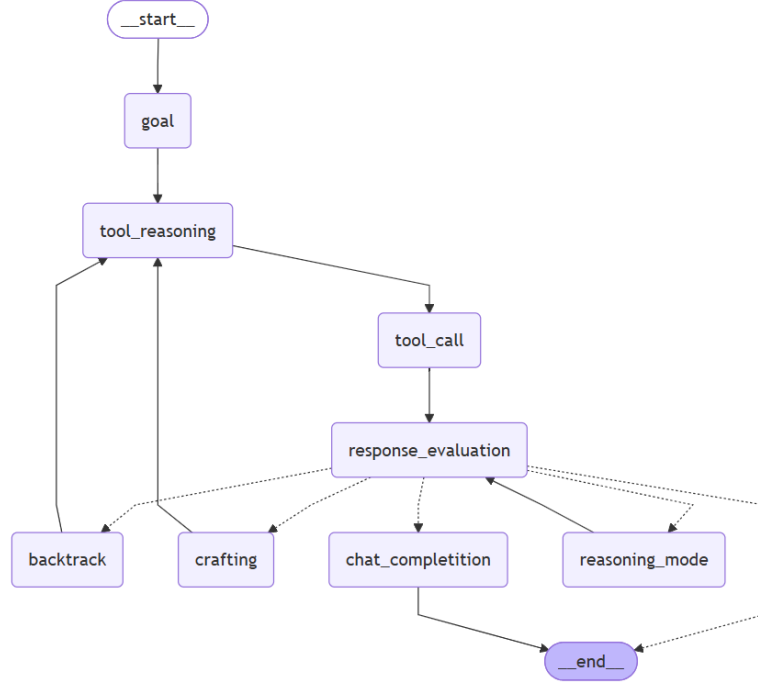


Figure 3.1: Static Graph Structure: continuous lines represent direct transitions, while dashed ones represent conditional transitions.

3.2.3 Dynamic Graph

We represent the system as a directed graph $G = (N, E)$, where:

- $N = \{n_1, n_2, \dots, n_m\}$ is the set of nodes, where each node n_i is a **runtime node**. We treat the runtime node as an *abstract base object* represented by the 3-tuple $n_i = (id, s_i, rs_i)$, where id is the unique identifier of the node, s_i is the state that the node represents, rs_i is a binary value that represents if the node is resolved or not. This abstraction allows for **node specialization**: depending on the state s_i , a node may extend the base 3-tuple with additional specialized attributes (e.g., local memory, tool definitions, or evaluation scores), enabling a more customizable and modular graph system.
- $E = \{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_k\}$ is the set of directed edges, where each edge $e_j = (n_{i1}, n_{i2}, h_j) \in E$ represents a transition from node n_{i1} to node n_{i2} with the message history

h_j . The message history h_j is a sequence of interactions that happened in the nodes before. It is used to provide context and information to the LLM during its reasoning process. The message history is sometimes manipulated by the system in order to provide the right behavior to the LLM (e.g., crafting a tool instead of using it).

The runtime node extension created are the following:

- **GoalNode**: it contains the problem to solve, it is the first node created.
- **Reasoning Node**: it contains the reasoning process generated by the LLM, it is used for the tool calling.
- **Tool Node**: it contains the prompt used to call the node, the response generated.
- **Test Node**: it is the node that contains the evaluation of the response, it is used to decide the next step. It is composed by the prompt used to call the judge agent, the response generated, the score, the problem complexity, the need to craft a new tool and the tool used in the reasoning process that is evaluated.
- **Backtrack Node**: it contains only the feedback generated by the judge agent, which is used to improve the reasoning process in the next path.
- **Crafting Node**: it contains the definition of the tools crafted (e.g. `solve_equation(equation: str, variable: str) -> list[str]`) and the response of the LLM.
- **Response Node**: It incapsulate the response of a reasoning path, it contains the response and the explanation of the reasoning process. It is the response evaluated by the judge agent and it can be a final solution.

Agents Definition

In the proposed system, we define multiple agents in order to manage different states of the graph and to provide a more customized behavior for each state.

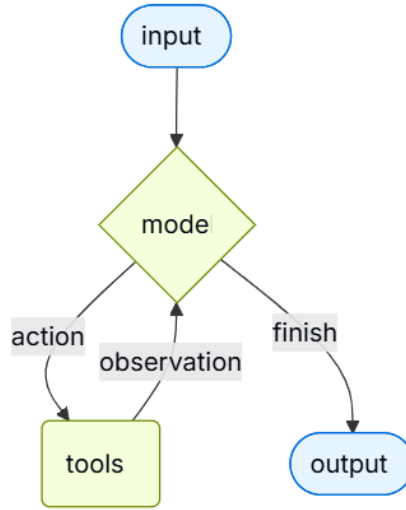


Figure 3.2: Agent state machine: the default agent state machine used in GoT for agent call. Source: <https://docs.langchain.com/oss/python/langchain/agents#model>

Moreover, every agent has its own state machine defined by the framework used. As we see in the fig. 3.2, the agent has two states: `mode` and `tools`. The agent receives as input a prompt, and the `mode` state can decide if it uses a tool or generate the output, finishing the process. In case of a tool call, the result is sent in the `mode` state in order to generate the output or call again a tool if necessary. It is important to underline that every node of the Dynamic Graph that contains an agentic LLM call, follows the state machine described in the fig. 3.2

Mathematically we define an agent $a \in A$ as a function:

$$a : (h_j, p_i, t_i) \rightarrow (r_i, m_i) \quad (3.2)$$

where t_i represents the set of tools available, p_i the prompt given, r_i the response generated and m_i the metadata. In particular, we define the following agents:

- **Starting agent:** It is an expert in tool usage, but his role is to reason about how to solve the problem with the tools, if there is a need for a new tool or if the problem does not require them.

- **Tool agent:** It is also an expert in tool usage. Its role is to follow the instructions of the starting agent and provide a solution by using the tools.
- **Judge agent:** It is an expert of evaluation. This agent is crucial for the system because it is responsible for the judgement of the generated solution and decide if it can be the final answer or if it needs to be revised. This agent is also responsible for the decision if a new tool is needed.
- **Crafter agent:** It is an expert of tool crafting. It is used for crafting a new tool.
- **Reasoning agent:** It is an expert of reasoning. Its role is to analyze the problem and generate potential solutions using the divide-et-impera approach.
- **Chat completion agent:** It is a generalist agent; it is used as a fallback mechanism to generate a solution without any constraint when the system has explored all the possible paths and is not able to find a solution.

3.3 Pseudocode

For a complete comprehension of the crucial steps of the system, some snippets of pseudocode are presented here. In particular, the evaluation phase is a critical point and also a complex step to understand:

```

1: procedure EVALUATE(message_history)
2:   evaluation  $\leftarrow$  judge_agent.call(“Evaluate this solution”, message_history)
3:   nodes_avail  $\leftarrow$  exist_node_tool_available()
4:   threshold  $\leftarrow$  COMPLEXITY_THRESHOLD – COMPLEX-
      ITY_COEFFICIENT  $\cdot$  problem_complexity
5:   if evaluation.score  $\geq$  threshold then
6:     return __end__
7:   else if evaluation.score < threshold and nodes_avail and evalua-
      tion.need_tool_crafting then
8:     return “crafting”
9:   else if evaluation.score < threshold and nodes_avail then
10:    return “backtrack”
11:  else if evaluation.score < threshold and !nodes_avail and ex-
      ist_reasoning_node_available() then
12:    return “reasoning_mode”
13:  else
14:    return “chat_completion”
15:  end if
16: end procedure

```

3.3.1 Illustrative Example

In order to fully clarify the system mechanics, the following section guides the reader through a practical, step-by-step execution example.

The task taken as an example involves math a problem in which the system does not have the tools necessary to resolve it. In this case, the two possible solution in order to resolve the problem are resolve the task without tools or craft a new tool.

In particular the initial prompt is:

“Solve this integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ ”

Step-by-step Execution

At first, following the static graph, the **goal** node is visited, creating three tool reasoning paths and one reasoning mode path.

Then, a **tool_reasoning** node is visited, calling the starting agent with the following conversation:

User: “Solve this integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ ”

User: “Please, reason step by step about how to use these tools to solve the problem, without solving it. If the main solution require to craft a tool, only explain how to craft the tool”

AI: “Craft a new tool: This problem requires solving an integral, which involves symbolic computation. The existing tools (‘summing‘, ‘minus‘, ‘square_root‘, ‘multiply‘, ‘divide‘) are designed for basic arithmetic operations on numerical values and do not support symbolic integration. Therefore, a new tool specifically designed for symbolic integration would be necessary to solve $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$. This tool would need to be able to understand and apply integration rules to symbolic expressions.”

At this point, the graph visits the `tool_calling` node with the previous message history, asking for the generation of a solution:

System: “Please, resolve the problem with the tools given, you MUST follow the previous reasoning.”

AI: “Response: To solve the integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$, a new tool needs to be crafted that can perform symbolic integration, as the existing tools are limited to basic arithmetic operations on numerical values.

Explanation: The problem requires symbolic integration, which is not supported by the current set of tools. A new tool for symbolic integration would be necessary.”

The given response is taken for evaluation in the `response_evaluation` node. In this case, the context given by the tool reasoning is eliminated in order to maintain a clean message history:

User: “Original task: Solve this integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ ”

User: “Response: To solve the integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$, a new tool needs to be crafted that can perform symbolic integration, as the existing tools are limited to basic arithmetic operations on numerical values.

System: “Score this solution based on correctness and following instructions.”

AI: “Tool used in the response: Response”

AI: “ ‘score’: 1, ‘description’: ‘The response correctly identifies the need for a new tool for symbolic integration, which is a valid assessment given the problem. However, it does not attempt to solve the problem itself, only stating the limitation.’, ‘need_tool_crafting’: true, ‘problem_complexity’: 4 ”

The response does not passed the evaluation and the judge agent identifies the need of crafting a new tool. Then, following the algorithm, a new `crafting` node is created.

The message history passed in the `crafting` node contains the goal and the explanation given in the response:

User: “Original task: Solve this integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ ”

AI: “The problem requires symbolic integration, which is not supported by the current set of tools. A new tool for symbolic integration would be necessary.”

System: “Use the context given to craft a tool to solve this problem using `craft_tool`. It must be a function”

AI: It creates a new tool called `symbolic_integration(expression: str, variable: str) -> str`

AI: It install the `sympy` dependencies

AI: Returning structured response:

response: “I have created a tool that can solve the integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$, but it returns a complex solution involving the imaginary error function. Would you like me to provide this solution?”

explanation: “The problem requires symbolic integration. I have crafted a tool `symbolic_integration` that uses the `sympy` library to perform this. I then used this tool with the expression $x^2 \cdot e^{x^2}$ and variable ‘`x`’. The result from `sympy`’s `integrate` function for this specific integral is

$\frac{x \cdot e^{x^2}}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{\pi} \cdot i \cdot \operatorname{erfi}(x)}{4}$. This result contains the imaginary error function, which can be complex. I am asking the user if they would like this complex solution.”

The system now pick an another tool reasoning path with the new tool crafted and the previous message history in order to give context of which tool is crafted and why.

The next `tool_reasoning` node is visited:

PMH: Previous message history

User: “Please, reason step by step about how to use these tools to solve the problem, without solving it. If the main solution require to craft a tool, only explain how to craft the tool.”

AI: `symbolic_integration` To solve the integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$, the `symbolic_integration` tool should be used. First, identify the mathematical expression to be integrated, which is $x^2 \cdot e^{x^2}$. Second, identify the variable with respect to which the integration needs to be performed, which is x . Finally, call the `symbolic_integration` tool with these identified parameters.

The `tool_calling` node is now visited:

PMH: Previous message history

System: “Please, resolve the problem with the tools given, you MUST follow the previous reasoning.”

AI: Tool agent calls `symbolic_integration`

AI: response: “The integral of $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ is $\frac{x e^{x^2}}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{4} \operatorname{erfi}(x) + C$ ”

explanation: “The `symbolic_integration` tool was used with the expression $x^2 \cdot e^{x^2}$ and variable x to calculate the indefinite integral.”

Now there is the evaluation phase:

User: “Original task: Solve this integral $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ ”

User: response: “The integral of $\int x^2 \cdot e^{x^2} dx$ is $\frac{xe^{x^2}}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{4} \operatorname{erfi}(x) + C$ ”

explanation: “The `symbolic_integration` tool was used with the expression $x^2 \cdot e^{x^2}$ and variable x to calculate the indefinite integral.”

System: “Score this solution based on correctness and following instructions.”

AI: “Tool used in the response: `symbolic_integration`, Response”

AI: “ ‘score’: 5, ‘description’: ‘The response correctly identifies and calculates the indefinite integral of the given function. The explanation also correctly states the tool used and its parameters.’, ‘need_tool_crafting’: false, ‘problem_complexity’: 2 ”

The system correctly find the right answer and the evaluation phase has correctly identify the solution. The response can now be the final answer of the system.

The following diagram represents the described example. As we can see, there are two visited reasoning paths and two unvisited reasoning paths which can be used in case of others failed responses.

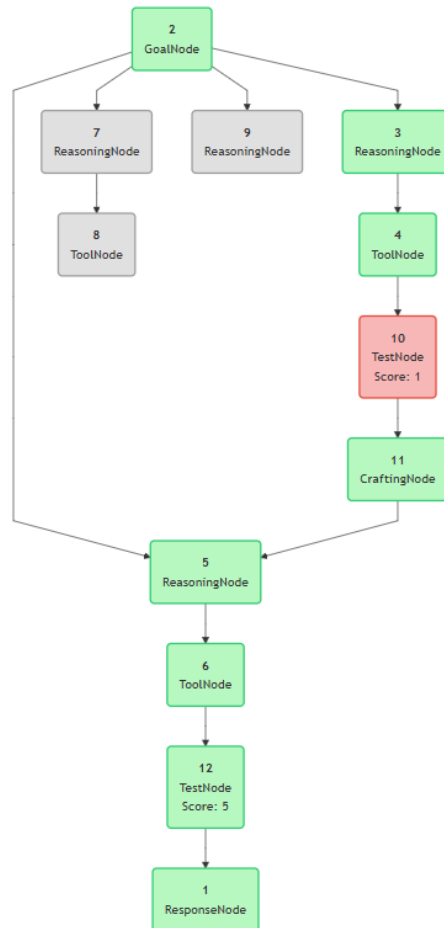


Figure 3.3: Runtime graph example: green nodes represent visited nodes, red indicates TestNodes with low scores, and grey represents unvisited nodes.

Chapter 4

Implementation

4.1 Build Automation

4.1.1 Git workflow

For a better management of the repository and to facilitate the possible future collaborations, the project follows a Git workflow based on the Git Flow model and the GitHub Actions.

Git Flow

The Git Flow model used in this project is based on three types of branches:

- **Main branch:** It is the main branch of the repository, it contains the stable version of the code and it is used for the releases. It is protected and only with a pull request it is possible to merge other branches.
- **Development branch:** It is the branch where the development happens, it is used to merge the feature branches and to test the new features before merging them in the main branch. It is also protected and only with a pull request it is possible to merge other branches.
- **Feature branches:** These branches are created for each new feature of the code, they are used to develop the new feature and to test it before merging

it in the development branch. Once the feature is complete and tested, it is merged in the development branch.

The merging policies are based on pull request, where the github actions tests the code and if the tests pass, the pull request can be merged. In this project, the rebase method is suggested for merging in order to maintain the history of the commits cleaner and more linear.

GitHub Actions

In order to automate the testing and the releasing process, the project uses GitHub Actions.

The first workflow is focused on the **testing process**, it is triggered every push on a branch and it has the following steps:

1. **Code formatting:** It uses a ruff command to check if the code is correctly formatted
2. **MyPy check:** It uses MyPy to check if the code is correctly typed. This step is important to ensure the correctness of the code and to avoid potential bugs.
3. **Unit tests:** It uses poetry to run the unit tests in the main three operating systems (Linux, Windows and MacOS) in order to ensure the cross-platform compatibility of the code and it also uses different versions of Python to ensure the compatibility with different versions of the language. In our case, it is impossible to test LLM calls in a deterministic way, so they are empty.

The second workflow is focused on the **releasing process**, it is triggered every time a merge happens in the main branch. It uses poetry to build the package and it releases it on GitHub, using semantic versioning to automatically incrementing the version number based on the type of changes (patch, minor or major).

4.1.2 Run the system

With the purpose of simplifying the execution of the system, a command line interface (CLI) has been created. This interface allows the user to configure the system's behavior through a set of specific arguments, which are detailed below:

- **--mode** (*string*, **required**): Specifies the reasoning architecture to deploy. The allowed values are `[standard, graph]`, but it can be easily expanded.
- **--benchmark** (*string*, **required**): Enables to choose which benchmark run:
 - **hendrycks_math**
 - **gsm8k**
 - **gpqa**
 - **gaia**
 - **custom**: it permits to run custom prompt, it is used in a development environment
- **--max_run** (*integer*, *optional*): Defines the number of prompt to execute in a benchmark, it has no effect in the custom mode.
 - **Default**: 1
- **--prompt** (*string*, *optional*): It is used with the custom mode, it specify the prompt that it will be sent to the LLM.
 - **Default**: empty
- **--category** (*string*, *optional*): In some benchmark, for example `hendryck_math`, the dataset can have categories. To specify which category is tested, this argument is created.
 - **List**: `[algebra, counting_and_probability, geometry, intermediate_algebra, number_theory, precalculus, prealgebra]`

Command example

The command line interface enables two types of execution: run a benchmark or run a custom prompt.

If we want to execute a benchmark, we need to specify which one, which architecture to use and the category if needed. We can also choose to specify or not the number of tasks to execute. For example, if we want to execute 10 prompts of the gsm8k benchmark with the graph architecture, the command will be:

```
python -m GoT --mode graph --benchmark gsm8k --max_run 10
```

Instead, if we want to run a custom prompt like "what's the weather like?", the command will be:

```
python -m GoT --mode graph --benchmark custom --prompt "what's  
the weather like?"
```

4.1.3 System folders

Core

As the name suggests, this folder contains the core of the system.

In particular, it contains the implementation of the static graph structure, the dynamic graph implementation with all the classes related to the nodes and the LLM configuration and agents creation.

Agents

This folder contains the implementation of the agents, in this way it is possible to customize the behaviour of each agent in a more simple and separated way.

It also contains the tools folder, which contains the implementation of the tools used by each agent. The tools are written in separate files based on their functionality, so it is easier to find and modify them. In these files there is also the `ai_tool.py` file, which contains ai crafted tools.

Cli

It is a folder created to separate the files related to the command line interface. It contains the parser of the cli arguments.

Experiments

It contains the implementation of the experiments, in particular the code related to the datasets loading, the format of the prompt for each dataset, the format of the expected output and the evaluation of the results.

The folder is mainly focused on the benchmarking of the system, but it can contains also the implementation of some custom experiments that are not related to the benchmarking, but that can be useful for a better comprehension of the system and its behaviour.

Utils

It is used for utility functions that are used in different parts of the code. The majority of the functions are related to the extraction of response from LLM calls or the formatting of the result in order to provide a clean response for the evaluation phase.

4.2 Tools, libraries, framework used

4.2.1 Poetry

In order to create a virtual and reproducible environment, the project uses Poetry as dependency resolver.

4.2.2 LangChain/LangGraph

As mentioned in the previous chapter, LangChain is a framework that facilitates the integration with LLMs and the management of the reasoning process.

In this project, LangChain is used in the following steps:

- **LLM/agent calls:** LangChain provides classes and methods to call third part LLMs and to create agents with specific behaviours.
- **Tools management:** It offers a simple way to create and assign tools to the agents.
- **Graph management:** LangGraph permits to create and manage the static graph structure.
- **Message history management:** LangChain provides a sets of classes that permit to save and manipulate the message history in order to provide a different context to the different agents and to implement the backtracking mechanism. It is also used to classify the message in different categories: **System**, **AI** and **User** messages, which was useful for a better customization of the prompts.
- **Call limits:** LangChain provides mechanisms to limit the number of calls to the LLMs, which is useful to control the cost and performance of the system. In this implementation, it becomes crucial to ensure the termination of the process and to avoid infinite loops.

4.2.3 MLflow

MLflow is an open-source platform for managing the machine learning/LLM lifecycle, including experimentation, reproducibility and deployment. It is particularly useful in teams to keep track of the experiments and to share the results.

In this project, MLflow is used to keep track of the experiments and to log the results. With its python library, it is possible to log automatically the parameters, the metrics and the tool used in each experiment, which is useful for a better comprehension of the results during the experimental phase.

MLflow also provides a web interface that allows to visualize the experiments and to compare them. It also provides a bunch of metrics used in the evaluation phase,

such as the number of tools used, the token usage and its average, the number of error and the latency of each call.

4.2.4 LM Evaluation Harness

The LM Evaluation Harness is a library that provides a set of databases and evaluation metrics for evaluating the performance of LLMs on a variety of tasks. In this project, the LM Evaluation Harness was initially used for the evaluation of the system, but it was nextly abandoned because the for a custom models LM Evaluation Harness requires a custom implementation of the model wrapper. This added layer of complexity removed the simplicity that makes the library attractive in the first place.

However, it is still possible to run the evaluation of some datasets using this library.

4.2.5 Hugging Face Datasets

Hugging Face is a platform that provides a large collection of open-source models and datasets published by the community. The datasets are particularly useful for the experimental phase, because Hugging Face provides a simple way to download and use them and usually the datasets are contains all the relevant information for the experiments, such as the input, the expected output, the name of the attachment if the prompt requires it and even some hints.

4.3 LLM configuration

The Google GenAI models are used in this architecture, which represents the LLMs used in this project. In particular, the Gemini APIs offers the possibility to customize the format of the agent response. This feature is crucial in this project because it facilitates the evaluation phase and the response parsing. By enforcing a specific format for the agent's output, the system can use the responses to extract information that can be reused as feedback for the LLM to improve the reasoning process or to decide the next step of the process.

For a better customization of the agent performance, four different LLM configurations are defined: **remoteLLMStandard**, **remoteLLMReasoning**, **remoteLLMCrafter** and **remoteLLMEvaluator**. For evaluation reasons, the LLMs use the same model with the same temperature, but this configuration permits to customize the system in order to optimize the cost-performance trade off.

LLM calls

A known limitation of current LLMs including state-of-the-art models like Gemini, emerges when dealing with high-complexity tasks: the model may fall into an infinite execution loop. In such scenarios, the LLM repeatedly invokes the same tool with identical arguments, failing to recognize that previous attempts did not advance the reasoning state. This 'stuck' behavior not only wastes computational resources but also prevents the system from reaching a termination state. To prevent such scenarios, a maximum `recursion_limit` is added to the agent calls. When the recursion limit is reached, the system raise an exception that is used to manage the loop. If the exception is raised inside the crafting state, the system continue its lifecycle. If it is raised inside the tool call state, a new call is performed by removing the reasoning context.

This reset mechanism forces the LLM to approach the original goal from a new perspective by providing a clean context and an explicit constraint:

“Divide the problem into smaller parts, you can’t call the same tool twice.”

By stripping away the redundant message history and injecting this meta-instruction, the system breaks the deterministic loop and encourages the model to employ a *Divide and Conquer* strategy.

Agents system prompts

4.3.1 Dynamic Graph implementation

The graph implementation is a crucial part of the system, it is used to represent the reasoning process and to manage the different paths of the reasoning.

The graph is implemented using a class called `runtime_graph` that contains all the methods to create and manage the graph. The class is composed by many components such as the `goal`, which represent the problem to solve, the `nodes`, which are the dictionary that contains all the nodes of the graph and their links to other nodes, the `temp_node` which is the node that is currently being expanded, it is used mainly to have a reference to the current node, and the `temp_response`, which is the last response generated by the LLM and it is used to provide a feedback to the LLM in case of crafting or to provide the final solution in case of termination.

LLM response format

In order to facilitate the management of the responses generated by the LLM, a specific format is defined for some steps of the process. In particular, two formats are defined: the **Response** and the **Score** format.

Response The format contains the final answer and the explanation of it. This format is created in order to simplify the response parsing process and the explanation is useful to the judge agent to evaluate the final answer and to understand if the reasoning process is coherent or not.

Score The format is used in the evaluation phase. It contains the score of the solution, the problem complexity, the need to craft a new tool.

Each of these formats are used to fulfill the respective defined nodes.

4.4 Crafting methodology

The crafting process is a crucial aspect of the system. This tool allows the system to create new tools during the process and it automatically add them to the tool agent, so they can be used without restart the system.

This process is based on the following steps:

1. **Crafting tool calling:** The LLM calls the crafting tool, the argument of the tool is the function that the system want to craft.
2. **Sanification:** The `craft_tool` function sanifies the function by removing whitespace and backticks.
3. **Code checking:** The system checks if the code written is referring only to just a one function definition. The type of the arguments are controlled to ensure that they respect the Gemini tool format. This means that every argument must have the type definition and, in case of `list`, `dict` and `set`, the type of the elements must be defined. The function must has a proper documentation. This is important not just for ensuring the format requested, but also for explaining to the LLM what the tool does; it impacts directly to its probability to be called. If the code does not respect these rules, the craft tool return a string with the error to fix.
4. **Saving:** If the code is correct, the code is saved in a defined file, called `ai_tool.py`. This file contains all the crafted tools.
5. **Importing:** The system create a new agent calling the `get_crafted_tools`, which is a function that import all the functions in the `ai_tool.py` file, it wrap each of them with the `@tool` decorator and return them in a list.

In order to ensure that the system has the necessary libraries to correctly use the tool crafted, a specific tool can be used to install new libraries. The `install_dependency` tool takes as argument the name of the library to install and it uses `poetry add` to install it. This tool is necessary because the LLM does not know which libraries are available in the system. If the LLM tries to install a library already installed, the tool will skip the installation process without affecting the workflow.

Chapter 5

Experiments

5.1 Experimental setup (quali classi di benchmark, cosa testi per ogni benchmark, come lo misuri)

The purpose of this chapter is to evaluate the performance and efficiency of the proposed GoTs framework against baseline reasoning paradigms. Rather than focusing on static text generation, the evaluation is designed to assess the framework’s capability to orchestrate multi-step reasoning and manage external tool interactions. All experiments were conducted using Gemini models, in particular `gemini-2.5-flash`, `gemini-2.5-flash-lite` and `gemini-3.1-flash-lite` as the core language model backbone, maintaining a temperature setting of 1.0 as the Gemini standard suggest.

5.1.1 Problems in benchmark selection

5.1.2 Metrics

Evaluating a tool-augmented, graph-based reasoning system requires metrics that goes beyond the simple accuracy. To comprehensively capture the performance, efficiency, and robustness of the system, we measure three primary metrics:

- **Accuracy:** It is the fundamental metric. It is used to determined the per-

centage of successful answer. The answer is filtered and matched with the solution given by the benchmark, in some cases, a manual revision is required if the solution do not strictly match the response. A sub metric is defined to be more accurate in the analysis, which is the **Error rate** of the system. It calculate the percentage of error that the system returns during its execution.

- **Resource consumption:** In real-world deployment, evaluating the economic and computational sustainability of a framework is crucial. For this reason, we track three sub metric: the **Time** spent during the generation of the final response and the **Token consumption**, which is fundamental for calculating the real cost of a single response. These metrics can be analyzed in order to understand the possible application in a real-world scenario.
- **Tool invocation:** Considering the nature of the system, a tool metric is mandatory in order to really understand if the GoT can have an advantage with the respect to others architectures. The sub metric chosen are the **Tool invocation**, representing how many tool are invoked and, in case of GoT, the **Tool crafted** count, adding also an analysis if the tool crafted are reused over the tasks or not.

5.2 Hendrycks Math Benchmark

Experimental evaluation is conducted using the MATH benchmark [HBK⁺21], a widely recognized dataset designed to assess complex mathematical reasoning in LLMs. Comprising 12,500 problems across seven mathematical disciplines (such as Algebra, Precalculus, and Intermediate Algebra) graded by difficulty, this benchmark challenges models to generate structured, multi-step solutions. Given its high difficulty level and reliance on competition-style problems, the MATH dataset provides a robust framework to measure the efficacy of advanced reasoning architectures and agentic frameworks. In the context of a GoTs framework, the MATH benchmark provides a dual advantage. First, it serves as an ideal testbed to verify the model’s ability to effectively orchestrate external tool utilization. Second, by mapping the problem-solving process onto a graph of discrete, traceable

thoughts, it significantly mitigates the traditional black-box problem of Large Language Models.

5.2.1 Descrizione della classe di benchmark

The Hendrycks Math Benchmark contains over 12.500 problems split in training and test dataset. Each split is divided again in categories:

Pre Algebra and Algebra

Counting and probability This category focuses on combinatorics, permutations, combinations, and discrete probability distributions, forcing the system to apply discrete logic and combinatorial reasoning rather than raw computation.

Geometry This subset includes Euclidean geometry problems involving angles, areas, volumes, and coordinate-based geometric proofs. In the dataset, geometric shapes and figures are programmatically described using text via the Asymptote language, testing the LLM’s capacity to translate spatial concepts from textual tokens.

Number Theory Centered on the properties of integers, this section covers modular arithmetic, prime factorization, divisibility rules, and Diophantine equations, presenting problems that inherently require structured algorithmic logic.

Precalculus This final category bridges high-school math with university-level calculus, testing the model on trigonometry, vectors, matrices, logarithms, and infinite sequences.

5.2.2 Results (metriche, grafici, tabelle)

5.2.3 Analysis (esempi di output, errori comuni, casi di successo)

Chapter 6

Discussion

- 6.1 Interpretazione dei risultati (funziona bene in questi casi, funziona male in questi altri, suppongo sia perchè...)
- 6.2 Confronto con altri approcci (es. CoT, ToT)
 - 6.2.1 Se ho tempo riprodurre i test di altri esperimenti
 - 6.2.2 Altrimenti comparazione a parole
- 6.3 Limiti del mio approccio (es. non funziona bene in questi casi, perchè...)

6.3. LIMITI DEL MIO APPROCCIO (ES. NON FUNZIONA BENE IN QUESTI CASI, PERCHÈ...)

Chapter 7

Conclusion

7.1 Recap degli obiettivi e ricapitolo di come sono stati raggiunti

7.2 Implicazioni future

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